AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
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SARS Approved PBO: 930092287
Section 18A approved: 9 October 2026
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CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Argon Asset Management × ASCO

Cape Town Youth Skills and Community Learning Initiative

Requested CSI investment: R75,000

Proposed implementation area: Newlands/Cape Town, Western Cape, South Africa, subject to beneficiary and implementation-site confirmation

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Argon Asset Management** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Cape Town Youth Skills and Community Learning Initiative**. The proposed request is **R75,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** Cape Town Youth Skills and Community Learning Initiative in Newlands/Cape Town, Western Cape, South Africa, subject to beneficiary and implementation-site confirmation, benefiting Proposed: youth in underserved Cape Town/Western Cape communities, with priority for learners and young people who can benefit from structured educational support, practical skills-sharing and community-development activities; final eligibility should be agreed with Argon and local stakeholders. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Argon Asset Management's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting
R75,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
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Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

The proposed project

Project title
Cape Town Youth Skills and Community Learning Initiative

Implementation period
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

Location
Newlands/Cape Town, Western Cape, South Africa, subject to beneficiary and implementation-site confirmation

Target beneficiaries
Proposed: youth in underserved Cape Town/ Western Cape communities, with priority for learners and young people who can benefit from structured educational support, practical skills-sharing and community-development activities; final eligibility should be agreed with Argon and local stakeholders.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: deliver a 12-month youth education and skills programme for approximately 60 young people.
- Proposed: provide at least 12 structured learning or skills-sharing sessions, with attendance and completion records.
- Proposed: support at least 3 community-led learning or service projects designed and implemented by participants.
- Proposed: provide baseline and endline feedback, participant demographic data collected appropriately, attendance records, outputs achieved and a short outcome report to the funder.
- Proposed: convene at least 2 community or caregiver engagement sessions to strengthen local ownership and longer-term prospects.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the

specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why Argon Asset Management?

ASCO's proposed youth and community-development work could cautiously align with Argon's expressly stated CSI emphasis on South African community upliftment, youth empowerment through education, skills-sharing and long-term impact. A Cape Town/Western Cape pilot would be geographically practical because Argon's listed office is in Newlands, Cape Town, while remaining consistent with Argon's broader South Africa scope. This is an alignment rationale only; it does not establish funding interest, partnership, approval or a commitment by Argon.

Verified company context

- Argon says its CSI programme aims at long-term community change in South Africa through direct community involvement, skills-sharing, time and financial support.
- Argon states that its CSI initiatives are largely focused on empowering youth through education, which it describes as a key enabler of lasting change.
- Argon says projects are generally short- to medium-term but are assessed by their intended significant, positive long-term impact on communities and individuals.
- Argon states that it considers environmental, social and governance issues in investment decisions and seeks a positive impact on society and the environment.
- Argon is an independent South African investment-management company; its official contact page lists its address as 1 Oakdale Road, Newlands, Cape Town, Western Cape, South Africa.
- Argon's 2024 B-BBEE certificate records a 6.00 score for Socio-Economic Development & Consumer Education and a Level One Contributor status; this is a compliance result, not a stated promise to fund a particular project.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R45,100	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R6,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R4,500	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R6,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R5,200	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R5,200	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R3,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	**R75,000**	**Equals the proposed request.**

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding
Company funds the proposed project at R75,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Primary official CSI route: csiteam@argonasset.co.za (Argon’s CSI page asks prospective parties to email the CSI Team for additional information). General route: info@argonasset.co.za, +27 (0)21 670 6570, or the official contact form at https://argonassetmanagement.co.za/contact-us/. No public CSI application form or deadline was found.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- Argon’s CSI page does not publish a formal eligibility checklist, funding limit, submission deadline, evaluation rubric, geographic restriction beyond South Africa, or required monitoring/reporting format.
- The official route identified is an email request to csiteam@argonasset.co.za for additional information; no public online CSI application form was found.
- Argon’s public CSI wording emphasizes education and youth empowerment, so a proposal should make the education, skills and measurable youth-development components explicit rather than present only general community activities.
- ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.
- No completed ASCO results, existing Argon/ASCO partnership, Argon commitment, or Argon-specific funding decision has been established.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Argon Asset Management** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

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Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://argonassetmanagement.co.za/csi/
2. https://argonassetmanagement.co.za/responsible-investing/
3. https://argonassetmanagement.co.za/contact-us/
4. https://argonassetmanagement.co.za/company-overview/
5. https://argonassetmanagement.co.za/wp-content/uploads/2024/11/Argon-Asset-Management-B-BBEE-Final-Report-2024.pdf

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.